

Paradiem 

The Morning Brief

SEPTEMBER 25, 2026

Yield Grind

Xi dinner buys runway without deliverables while yields press higher and energy bids on Iran snapback risk.

S&P 500 (SPY, THU CLOSE)

\$767.18 · ↓0.08%NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW
(DIA, THU)**\$741.10 ↓0.01% /
\$512.68 ↓0.32%**

TLT / WTI (USO, THU)

**\$79.42 ↓1.29% /
\$153.09 ↑2.86%**

AMD / KEYS (THU)

**\$629.26 ↑2.38% /
\$357.54 ↑1.18%**FEAR & GREED (CNN
STOCK)**Reportedly ~35 Fear
per Benzinga · Drop
reads 71 crypto
fallback**

SECTION 01

Markets — Yields Grind Higher as Indices Consolidate and Composition Bifurcates

DURATION REPORTEDLY COMPRESSES AGAIN — TLT ↓1.29%, XLB ↓1.19%, XLU ↓0.98%; OCTOBER HIKE ODDS REPORTEDLY NEAR ~73% PER CME FEDWATCH

Per data drop, Thursday's cash session reportedly delivered a shallow index compression with SPY ↓0.08% at \$767.18, QQQ essentially flat at \$741.10 ↓0.01%, DIA ↓0.32% at \$512.68, and IUSG (the FCI US growth benchmark) reportedly ↑0.10% at \$193.97, while UVXY (VIX proxy) reportedly rose ↑0.94% at \$17.20. Per CNBC, KuCoin, and Schwab coverage of the reported FedWatch tape, October 27–28 hike odds reportedly sit near approximately 73% for an additional +25 bp move (up from the reported ~66% level earlier in the week), with reported December odds now near approximately 58% for a follow-on hike — a hawkish-skewed path reportedly anchored by Chair Warsh's post-Jackson Hole communication and reinforced by Wednesday's reported flash PMI beats. Per Trading Economics coverage, the 10-year Treasury yield reportedly held near approximately 5.11–5.12% through Thursday and into the Friday setup — stabilizing rather than pushing further above the cycle-high print — and per data drop, TLT closed ↓1.29% at \$79.42 as the duration layer reportedly extended its compression. Per data drop, the sector tape reportedly bifurcated with XLC ↑1.27%, XLV ↑0.63%, and XLE ↑0.37% leading and XLB ↓1.19%, XLU ↓0.98%, XLP ↓0.89%, and XLI ↓0.75% lagging — a composition reportedly consistent with the reported rate-and-materials pressure running through the reported rate-sensitive layers. Per data drop, Carson's active SPY support level at \$645.80 (retracement target set April 13) remains untouched, with Thursday's reported intraday low of \$763.25 well above that level.

S&P 500 (SPY, THU CLOSE) **\$767.18 · ↓0.08% per data drop**
 NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW **\$741.10 ↓0.01% / \$512.68 ↓0.32% per data drop**
 (DIA, THU)
 TLT / 10- **\$79.42 ↓1.29% per data drop / Reportedly ~5.11-
 YEAR YIELD 5.12% per Trading Economics**
 FED OCT HIKE ODDS / **Reportedly ~73% Oct / ~58% Dec per
 DEC FOLLOW-ON CME FedWatch coverage**
 WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO, **\$153.09 ↑2.86% / \$61.84 ↑2.45% per
 THU) data drop**
 NAT GAS (UNG, THU) **\$11.55 ↑6.26% per data drop**
 CARSON'S ACTIVE SPY **\$645.80 retracement target · Untouched
 SUPPORT (Thu low \$763.25)**

**CHIP SLEEVE REPORTEDLY DIVERGES AROUND THE STATE
 DINNER — AMD ↑2.38%, KEYS ↑1.18%, CRDO ↑1.08%, TSM
 ↑1.03% VS NVDA ↓0.41%, QCOM ↓1.51%, NXPI ↓2.24%**

Per data drop, Thursday's FCI Growth-Hybrid semiconductor sleeve reportedly split around the reported East Room state dinner with AMD ↑2.38% at \$629.26 (reportedly regaining the reported trillion-dollar handle on the reported Lisa Su state-dinner attendance and continued AI-chip narrative), KEYS ↑1.18% at \$357.54, CRDO ↑1.08% at \$195.97, and TSM ↑1.03% at \$451.15, while NVDA reportedly closed ↓0.41% at \$224.58, MRVL ↓0.75% at \$258.95, QCOM ↓1.51% at \$194.26, and NXPI ↓2.24% at \$230.16 — and the FCI Dividend semiconductor and connector layer reportedly moved with ADI ↓0.68% at \$382.61, TEL ↓0.34% at \$213.67, and LRCX essentially flat at \$307.16 ↓0.04%. Per NPR, CBS, Local12, and Foreign Policy coverage of the Thursday evening state dinner, the reported tech-principal guest list reportedly included Nvidia's Jensen Huang, AMD's Lisa Su, Tesla's Elon Musk, Apple's Tim Cook, Amazon's Jeff Bezos, Meta's Mark Zuckerberg, OpenAI's Sam Altman and Greg Brockman, Microsoft's Satya Nadella, and Google's Sundar Pichai. Per Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the data drop holdings news, one piece reportedly framed AMD versus Nvidia as the primary AI-stock debate, and per Bloomberg and CNBC coverage of the summit outcomes, the reported bilateral discussion reportedly touched artificial intelligence, Taiwan, trade, and rare earths without reporting a comprehensive new agreement beyond the reported January 10, 2027 tariff truce runway announced by Treasury Secretary Bessent the prior day. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported AMD-and-KEYS-and-CRDO divergence higher into the state dinner, a reported NVDA-and-QCOM-and-NXPI drift lower,

and a reported enterprise-software drawdown alongside (NOW ↓2.13% at \$137.78, FTNT essentially flat at \$178.67 ↓0.04%, per data drop) — keeps NVDA, AMD, TSM, MRVL, LRCX, KEYS, CRDO, TEL, ADI, NOW, and FTNT reading through the intersection of the reported Fed rate path, the reported Pacific-technology channel, and the reported November 10 semiconductor export-control moratorium sitting behind the summit.

**RATE-SENSITIVES REPORTEDLY EXTEND LOWER — NEE
 ↓1.82%, EIX ↓1.81%; COST PRINTS REVENUE BEAT WITH EPS
 NEAR CONSENSUS PER DATA DROP**

Per data drop, Thursday's reported duration compression reportedly continued through the rate-sensitive layers with the FCI Dividend utility sleeve moving with NEE ↓1.82% at \$75.62 (and ATO essentially flat at \$156.42 ↑0.12%), the FCI Growth-Hybrid utility layer moving with EIX ↓1.81% at \$52.54 and VST essentially flat at \$137.94 ↓0.02%, and the FCI Dividend medical-and-consumer layer reportedly moving with ABT ↓2.34% at \$101.07, SYK ↓1.33% at \$269.75, and CHD ↓0.72% at \$95.33. Per 247 Wall Street, TradersAgency, and TheStreet coverage of the after-the-close print, Costco (COST) reportedly reported Q4 fiscal 2026 reported GAAP EPS of approximately \$6.75 versus reported consensus near approximately \$6.66 (reported beat), and per the same coverage, the reported figure reportedly included approximately \$0.15 per share of reported non-recurring IEEPA tariff-refund contributions — framing a reported underlying EPS near approximately \$6.60 essentially in line with reported consensus (approximately the reported \$6.60 figure carried in the data drop). Per the same coverage, revenue reportedly came in near approximately \$95.7 billion (versus reported consensus near approximately \$94.9 billion), reflecting reported comparable-sales growth near approximately 9.4% total (with reported digitally-enabled sales up approximately 19.5%) and reported FY26 revenue near approximately \$303.15 billion (up approximately 10.1% year-over-year). Per data drop earnings, Darden Restaurants (DRI) reportedly printed EPS of approximately \$2.05 versus reported consensus near approximately \$2.08 (marginal miss), TD Synnex (SNX) reportedly printed EPS of approximately \$5.68 versus reported consensus near approximately \$4.75 (reported beat), and Scholastic (SCHL) reportedly printed EPS of approximately -\$3.63 versus reported consensus near approximately -\$3.47 (reported miss). Per data drop, GD reportedly closed ↓2.05% at \$336.29 and LMT re-

portedly closed essentially flat at \$523.70 ↓0.19% into the reported Iran-snapback overhang, and per data drop, the pre-

cious-metals tape reportedly compressed with GLD ↓0.30% at \$391.69 and SLV ↓0.93% at \$57.62.

A shallow index compression against a chip-sleeve divergence around the Xi state dinner, a duration layer reportedly extending its compression on hawkish-skewed CME odds, and a Costco after-the-close print with a reported revenue beat against a reported EPS near consensus frame a Friday tape that tends to reward reading each catalyst on its own terms rather than compositing a single directional view. Research reveals opportunities.

SECTION 02

Geopolitics — Xi Dinner Cordial but Reportedly Light on Deliverables; Iran Snapback Window Opens Saturday

EAST ROOM DINNER REPORTEDLY LONG ON OPTICS, SHORT ON NEW DEALS — SHENZHEN AND MIAMI FOLLOW-ONS REPORTEDLY SCHEDULED BEYOND THE JANUARY 10 TRUCE RUNWAY

Per NPR, CBS, Local12, Bloomberg, and Foreign Policy coverage of the Thursday evening East Room state dinner, President Trump and General Secretary Xi Jinping reportedly hosted approximately 130 guests for a mutually cordial dinner following bilateral talks that reportedly covered trade, artificial intelligence, Taiwan, rare earths, and Iran — but per Bloomberg’s characterization of the summit as reportedly buying additional runway, and per CNBC and Foreign Policy coverage of the summit outcomes, no reported comprehensive new agreement was reportedly announced beyond the reported January 10, 2027 tariff truce extension unveiled by Treasury Secretary Bessent the prior day. Per NBC News and CBS coverage of the reported summit follow-on itinerary, two additional summits were reportedly scheduled — one reportedly in Shenzhen and one reportedly in Miami — framing a reported multi-touch diplomatic architecture behind the reported ~3.5-month tariff runway. Per NPR, CBS, and Local12 coverage of the reported guest list, the reported tech-principal contingent reportedly included Nvidia’s Jensen Huang, AMD’s Lisa Su, Tesla’s Elon Musk, Apple’s Tim Cook, Amazon’s Jeff Bezos, Meta’s Mark Zuckerberg, OpenAI’s Sam Altman and Greg Brockman, Microsoft’s Satya Nadella, and Google’s Sundar Pichai — and per the same coverage, one notable absence reportedly framed across the reporting was Anthropic. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported cordial-but-hollow-of-deliverables dinner, a reported January 10 truce runway with two reported follow-on summits sitting behind, a still-live reported November 10 semiconductor export-control moratorium expiration, and a reported rare-earth compliance thread carried across the prior-brief coverage — keeps NVDA, AMD, TSM, QCOM, MRVL, LRCX, KEYS, TEL, NXPI, ADI, CRDO, FCX, and NTR reading through the intersection of the reported Pacific-technology channel, the reported Fed rate path, and the reported critical-minerals overhang into the balance of the quarter.

PEZESHKIAN REPORTEDLY DEFIANT, KHAMENEI REPORTEDLY REJECTS DIRECT NUCLEAR TALKS — UN SNAPBACK SANCTIONS REPORTEDLY LOOM SATURDAY, WTI REPORTEDLY BIDS +2.86%

Per Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, CFR, and JTA coverage of the Wednesday and Thursday Iran sequence, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian reportedly maintained a defiant tone at the UN General Assembly (reportedly reaffirming Iran’s reported enrichment position and reportedly stating Iran is

ready for dialogue but not under the language of force), and per the same coverage, Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei reportedly publicly rejected direct US nuclear talks ahead of the Pezeshkian departure — framing a reported diplomatic ceiling on any near-term de-escalation channel. Per Bloomberg and CNBC coverage of the reported UN sequence, the reported snapback-style sanctions mechanism reportedly comes into focus Saturday absent a reported European deal, and per data drop, Thursday’s energy tape reportedly moved with

WTI (USO) ↑2.86% at \$153.09, Brent (BNO) ↑2.45% at \$61.84, and Nat Gas (UNG) ↑6.26% at \$11.55, with the FCI Growth-Hybrid energy layer reportedly moving with CVX essentially flat at \$205.65 ↑0.07% and OKE ↑0.71% at \$91.18 alongside CNX ↑1.24% at \$33.41. Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, multiple pieces reportedly framed oil as sliding on US-Iran truce hopes outweighing Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia, and per separate Reuters coverage carried in the drop, another piece reportedly framed Iran's president as stating it is up to the US to choose if it wants to end the

reported Iran war. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported Iranian defiance-plus-diplomacy tone, a reported Khamenei rejection of direct nuclear talks, a reported UN snapback window opening Saturday, and a reported physical-crude bounce reportedly running through the ETF proxies — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, and GD reading through the intersection of the reported sanctions perimeter, the reported UNGA overhang, and the reported physical-crude signal into the weekend.

On Our Radar

1. Today — Durable Goods Orders (Aug) at 8:30 AM ET, Reported Consensus Near ~-0.3% vs Prior Reported ~+1.1%; Final Michigan Sentiment Also on the Docket. Per Investing.com and ForexFactory coverage of the reported US economic calendar, August Durable Goods Orders reportedly releases today at 8:30 AM ET with reported consensus near approximately -0.3% versus a reported prior month print near approximately +1.1%, framing the reported factory-cycle read that sits into the reported FCI industrial-and-Dividend sleeve (CAT, PCAR, FAST, ADP, GD, LMT) and the reported Fed rate path against the Wednesday flash PMI beats. Per the same calendar coverage, the reported University of Michigan final consumer sentiment print reportedly releases later in the morning. Per data drop earnings calendar, today's reported list is limited (FGPR reports with no reported consensus, TBN reports with reported consensus near approximately -\$0.17), framing a light corporate-catalyst backdrop against the data print. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Durable Goods print into the reported ~73% October CME hike odds, a reported final Michigan sentiment read, and a reported light earnings docket — keeps the investment committee reading through Friday's tape ahead of the reported weekend Iran snapback window and the reported Monday setup.

2. COST Q4 FY26 — Revenue Reportedly Beats at ~\$95.7B, GAAP EPS Reportedly ~\$6.75 vs ~\$6.66 Est (~\$0.15 From Reported IEEPA Tariff Refunds); Comps Reportedly ~+9.4%. Per 247 Wall Street, TradersAgency, and TheStreet coverage of the Costco (COST) Q4 fiscal 2026 after-the-close print, reported GAAP EPS reportedly came in near approximately \$6.75 versus reported consensus near approximately \$6.66 (reported beat), with the reported figure reportedly including approximately \$0.15 per share of reported non-recurring IEEPA tariff-refund contributions — framing a reported underlying EPS near approximately \$6.60 essentially in line with reported consensus (the reported figure carried in the data drop). Per the same coverage, revenue reportedly came in near approximately \$95.7 billion (versus reported consensus near approximately \$94.9 billion), reported comparable-sales growth reportedly grew near approximately 9.4% total (with reported digitally-enabled sales up approximately 19.5%), and reported FY26 revenue reportedly came in near approximately \$303.15 billion (up approximately 10.1% year-over-year). Per the same coverage, the reported after-hours reaction was reportedly modestly positive pending confirmation on the live tape. For FCI positioning — a reported COST revenue beat and reported comp-growth print alongside reported EPS near consensus with a reported member-value reinvestment framing — sits as a reference point for the FCI Dividend consumer-staples-adjacent sleeve reading (CHD, CL, ABT, SYK, DGX) into the Friday tape.

3. AMD Reportedly Regains Trillion-Dollar Handle — +2.38% at \$629.26 Around Reported State-Dinner Head Table; TSM +1.03%, KEYS +1.18%, CRDO +1.08% Also Bid. Per data drop, Thursday's FCI Growth-Hybrid chip-equipment-and-connector layer reportedly bid with AMD ↑2.38% at \$629.26 (reportedly regaining the reported trillion-dollar handle), TSM ↑1.03% at \$451.15, KEYS ↑1.18% at \$357.54, and CRDO ↑1.08% at \$195.97, while NVDA reportedly closed ↓0.41% at \$224.58, MRVL ↓0.75%, QCOM ↓1.51%, and NXPI ↓2.24%. Per NPR and CBS coverage of the reported state-dinner guest list, Lisa Su's reported attendance alongside Jensen Huang, Elon Musk, and Tim Cook reportedly framed the AI-chip principals in the same room. Per SeekingAlpha coverage carried in the data drop, one piece reportedly framed CRDO as a buy on reported photonics-and-optics shortages. For FCI positioning — a reported AMD trillion-dollar recapture into a reported NVDA-and-QCOM drift — keeps NVDA, AMD, TSM, MRVL, QCOM, NXPI, LRCX, KEYS, CRDO, TEL, and ADI reading through the reported Pacific-technology channel and the reported November 10 export-control moratorium.

4. Iran Snapback Window Reportedly Opens Saturday; Energy Bid Extends, Rate-Sensitives Compress. Per Bloomberg, CNBC, and CFR coverage of the reported UN sequence, the reported snapback-style sanctions mechanism reportedly opens Saturday absent a reported European deal. Per data drop, Thursday's energy tape reportedly moved with WTI (USO) ↑2.86% at \$153.09, Brent (BNO) ↑2.45% at \$61.84, and Nat Gas (UNG) ↑6.26% at \$11.55, alongside OKE ↑0.71% and CNX ↑1.24%. Per data drop, the reported rate-sensitive layer reportedly extended lower with NEE ↓1.82%, EIX ↓1.81%, ABT ↓2.34%, SYK ↓1.33%, and GD ↓2.05%, alongside XLU ↓0.98% and XLB ↓1.19%. For FCI positioning — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, GD, NEE, EIX, ABT, and SYK reading through the reported sanctions perimeter and the reported Fed rate path into the weekend.

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